

MS EXCEL

Sort By More Than Three Columns

Excel's sort feature only allows it to nominate up to three columns to sort by. The key to this is sorting by the last key first and working back to the first key. Say your data is in Columns A:E, and you want to sort by A, B, C, D then E. Select all the columns A:E. Go to **Data > Sort > Sort by C then by D then by E**. Click 'Sort'. Now again with Columns A:E selected, go to **Data > Sort > Sort by A then by B**. Click 'Sort'.

Entering Named Ranges Into Formulas

When you write a formula, sometimes you want to use a Named Range as one of the arguments for the formula, but you cannot remember the name.

In these cases, simply press [F3] when you reach the argument that you want the Named Range in, and Excel will display the 'Paste Name' dialog. Click the name you want, and click 'OK'.

Catching Formula Errors

Whenever typing one of Excel's functions, especially nested ones, into a cell, use lowercase. This way when you press [Enter], Excel will capitalise only the names of the functions you have entered correctly.

Transpose Formulas Without The Reference Changing

In cell A1 of sheet 2, put `"=Sheet1!A1"`. Copy this a maximum of 255 rows. Now with the formulas selected, go to **Edit > Replace**, and Replace "=" with "#". Now select and copy cell B1, go to **Edit > Paste special**, and choose 'Transpose'. Delete column A, and with row 1 selected, go to **Edit > Replace**, and Replace "#" with "=".

Display Or Hide Scrollbars

Go to **Tools > Options > View**. Select or clear the 'Horizontal scroll bar' checkbox and 'Vertical scroll bar' checkbox.

Add Colour To Sheet Tabs

First select the sheets you want to colour. On the 'Format' menu, point to 'Sheet', and then click 'Tab Color'. You can also right-click on the sheet tab and then click 'Tab Color'. Click on the colour you want and click 'OK'.

Four Conditional Formatting Options

Conditional formatting in Excel allows for three conditions. However, by setting up conditions correctly—from least to most restrictive—you can really allow for four conditions, when the default formatting of the cell is considered.

For example, say you want to add colour to your data in the following manner. You have four ranges, with fill colours Red, Yellow, Green and Black respectively. The four ranges are "Less than or equal to -25", "Between 0 and -25", "Between 0 and 25", and "Over 25". This can be achieved by doing the following.

First select your range of cells. Click 'Conditional Formatting' on the 'Format' menu. Under 'Condition 1', in the first two boxes, choose 'Cell Value Is' and 'less than or equal to' respectively. Then type the value "-25" in the third box. Now click the 'Format' button, choose a red fill colour from the 'Patterns' tab, and click 'OK'. Click 'Add'. Under 'Condition 2', choose between in the second box, type the values "0" and "-25" in the third and fourth boxes, and then choose a yellow fill format. Click 'Add' again.

Under 'Condition 3', choose 'Between' in the second box, type the values "0" and "25" in the third and fourth boxes, and then choose a green fill format. Click 'OK' to close the 'Conditional Formatting' dialog box. Finally, while your range is still highlighted, choose a black fill from the colour palette. Your range is now pseudo-conditionally formatted to cover all four cases!

Change Cell Background Colour Using VBA

To modify the background colour of a cell using Visual Basic for Applications (VBA), you need to use the 'Interior' property of the cell, and then you can use `ColorIndex` (to use one of the 56 'preset' colours in Excel) in this way, for example:

`ActiveCell.Interior.ColorIndex = 36` Instead of 'ColorIndex', you can use 'Color'. In this example, you are colouring cells A1 through A6: `Range("A1:A6").Interior.Color = RGB(200,160,35)`

View Multiple Sheets Or Workbooks

To view multiple sheets or workbooks at the same time, open the workbooks you want to view. To view multiple sheets in the active workbook, click 'New Window' on the 'Window' menu. Switch to the new window, and then click a sheet you want to view. Repeat for each sheet you want to view. On the 'Window' menu, click 'Arrange'. Under 'Arrange', click the option you want.

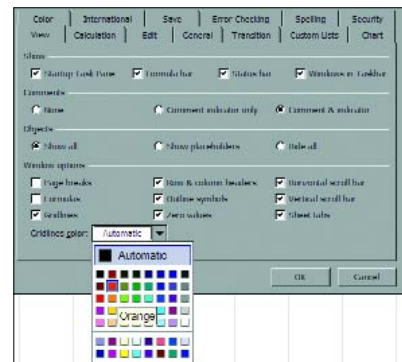
In order to view sheets in only the active workbook, select the 'Windows of active workbook' checkbox.

Change The Colour Of Cell Gridlines

Select the sheets on which you want to change the gridline colour. Go to **Tools > Options**, and then click the 'View' tab. Under 'Window options', click the colour you want in the 'Color' box. To use the default gridline colour, click 'Automatic'.

Change The Hole Size In A Doughnut Chart

Click a data series in the doughnut chart you want to change. On the 'Format' menu, click 'Selected Data Series', and then click the 'Options' tab. In the 'Doughnut hole size' box, type a value between 10



Changing gridline colour in Excel

and 90 to specify the diameter of the hole.

Change The Plotting Order Of Data Series

Click a data series in the chart you want to change. To change the plotting order of data series in a surface chart, click a legend key. On the 'Format' menu, click 'Selected Data Series' or 'Selected Legend Key', and then click the 'Series Order' tab.

In the 'Series order' box, click the series you want to move. To place the series in the order you want, click 'Move Up' or 'Move Down'.

Change The Cell Range A Chart Is Based On

Click the chart you want to change. On the 'Chart' menu, click 'Source Data', and then click the 'Data Range' tab. Make sure the entire reference in the 'Data range' box is selected.

On the worksheet, select the cells that contain the data you wish to appear in the chart. If you want the column and row labels to appear in the chart, include the cells that contain them in the selection.

MS OUTLOOK

Display Non-consecutive Dates

The Outlook Calendar displays dates consecutively—usually in single week or month view. But sometimes it's useful to see several non-consecutive, key dates at a glance. For example, if you met with the same client on January 12